

# Nepal Traffic Rules — Quick Reference (RAG-Optimized)

Legal basis: Motor Vehicles and Transport Management Act, 2049 (1993). Enforced by: Nepal Traffic Police & Department of Transport Management (DoTM).

---

## Basic Rules

- Drive on the **left** side of the road; overtake from the **right**.
- Obey traffic lights: Red = stop, Yellow = slow down, Green = go with caution.
- Seat belts required for driver + front passengers. Helmets required for both motorcycle rider and pillion.
- Triple riding on a motorcycle is banned.
- Use turn indicators before turning, changing lanes, or merging.
- Give way to ambulances, fire trucks, police, and any vehicle with active siren/lights.
- Overtaking banned on curves, bridges, crossings, intersections, school zones.

## Speed Limits

| Area         | Limit                  |
|--------------|------------------------|
| Urban/City   | 40 km/h                |
| Highways     | 70-80 km/h             |
| Residential  | ~30 km/h               |
| School zones | Reduced (posted signs) |

## Required Documents (carry at all times)

- Driving License (physical or digital via Nagarik App)
- Vehicle Registration Certificate (Bluebook)
- Insurance Certificate (third-party liability is compulsory)
- Pollution Under Control (PUC) Certificate where required

## Drunk Driving

- **Zero tolerance** — BAC limit 0.00%.
- License seized on the spot; fine Rs. 1,000-1,500.
- Mandatory 1-hour alcohol awareness class before license returned.
- 5 “hole punches” (repeat offenses) = license permanently revoked.
- Death caused while drunk driving = imprisonment + permanent license revocation.

## Mobile Phone Use

- Handheld phone use while driving is banned. Fine Rs. 1,000-2,000. Hands-free allowed.

## License & Registration

- Must score  $\geq 70/100$  on driving test to get a license (“70 Rule”).

- Driving without license: fine up to Rs. 5,000 + possible impoundment.
- Vehicle must be registered with DoTM; Bluebook renewed annually.

## Vehicle Modifications

- No changes to color, engine, seats, or structure without DoTM approval.
- Exhaust noise limit: 84 decibels.
- Fine: Rs. 5,000-10,000 + possible impoundment.

## Demerit Point System

- Each offense adds 2-5 points; points expire after 1 year.
- 12 points = license suspended for 6 months.

## Fine Schedule (NPR)

| Violation                   | Fine         | Extra                  |
|-----------------------------|--------------|------------------------|
| No helmet                   | 500-1,500    | Demerit points         |
| No seat belt                | 500-1,500    | Demerit points         |
| Drunk driving               | 1,000-1,500  | License seized + class |
| Triple riding               | 500          | Demerit points         |
| Phone use while driving     | 1,000-2,000  | License may be seized  |
| Red light violation         | 500-1,500    | CCTV tracked           |
| Speeding                    | 500-3,000    | Severity-based         |
| No license                  | 1,000-5,000  | Impoundment            |
| Wrong overtaking/lane       | 1,500        | Demerit points         |
| Illegal parking             | 1,000        | + towing               |
| Overloading                 | 500-3,000+   | Seizure on repeat      |
| No insurance                | 2,000-5,000  | Impoundment            |
| Illegal modification        | 5,000-10,000 | Impoundment            |
| Ignoring officer signal     | 1,500        | Demerit points         |
| Smoking in public transport | 1,000        | —                      |
| Hit and run                 | Heavy fine   | Court case + prison    |

Repeat offense escalation: 1st = Rs. 500, 2nd = Rs. 1,000, 3rd+ = Rs. 1,500.

## Pedestrian Rules

- Use zebra crossings and footpaths where available.
- Vehicles must yield to pedestrians at crossings.
- Extra care required near schools and disabled pedestrians.

## Digital Enforcement

- **Nagarik App**: pay fines, store digital license/documents, view e-Challan.
- CCTV, GoPro body cams, and AI cameras (pilot) used for monitoring, mainly in Kathmandu Valley.
- Camera-issued fines are legally valid; can be contested via administrative/judicial channels.

## **Foreign Drivers**

- Valid International Driving Permit (IDP) allows driving for up to 90 days.
- Beyond 90 days: must convert to a Nepalese license.
- Same rules, fines, and camera citations apply as to locals.

## **Serious Offenses (go to court, not just fines)**

- Hit and run
- Death/injury from reckless driving
- Forged/fake license
- Defying traffic police authority
- Drunk driving causing death

## **Key Contacts**

- Nepal Traffic Police: [www.nepalpolice.gov.np](http://www.nepalpolice.gov.np)
- Department of Transport Management: [www.dotm.gov.np](http://www.dotm.gov.np)
- Fine payment: Nagarik App (Android & iOS)

## **Note**

A new draft law (Vehicle and Transport Management Act, 2081 BS) is under review and is expected to raise penalties and require high-security embossed number plates once passed.